

Monday, 3 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

32° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

32° 16°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

29° 18°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

20° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 The Prime Minister, Andy Burnham, has pledged to be 'relentless' in his efforts to curb small boat crossings into the UK.

He stated that enforcement measures are being increased, but also emphasised the need for more safe and legal routes for people to enter the country.

POLITICS · UK

2 A man has admitted to killing a Scottish woman whose body was tragically discovered in a suitcase in Greece.

The 38-year-old victim, Elisabeth-Jane Ross, was found in a suitcase, and the man has been arrested on suspicion of her murder, as well as robbery and weapons offences.

CRIME · UK

3 The body of renowned mountaineer Nirmal Purja has been recovered after he was caught in an avalanche in Pakistan.

Purja was famous for his incredible feat of scaling the world's 14 highest peaks in just over six months back in 2019. It's a sad loss for the climbing world.

ACCIDENT · UK

4 Commuters travelling in and out of London faced significant disruption over the weekend as trains were halted due to a trackside fire.

The incident led to widespread delays and cancellations, affecting thousands of passengers. Fire services were called to tackle the blaze.

TRANSPORT · UK

5 Four people have been arrested in connection with a hate crime attack on a ship's crew, which left one man seriously injured.

Three of those arrested are being held on suspicion of attempted murder. Police are continuing their investigations into the incident.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Spider-Man fans are absolutely buzzing about Tom Holland's latest web-slinging adventure, hailing 'Brand New Day' as his best performance yet!**

It seems the new film has truly captured the hearts of audiences, with many praising Holland's portrayal of the iconic superhero. Early reviews are incredibly positive.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Spider-Man films? Which one is your favourite?

FILM · COMING UP
- 2 London is set to host the debut of the Mahrajan Festival, a huge milestone for the Arabic community in the capital!**

The festival promises to be a vibrant celebration of Arabic music and culture, featuring performances from artists like Saint Levant and Dystinct. It's a brand new event for the city.

ON AIR – What kind of music festivals are you looking forward to this summer?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 3 It's been a decade of Spider-Man romance for Zendaya and Tom Holland, and fans are loving a look back at their journey!**

The couple, who recently tied the knot, have been a fixture at premieres for 10 years. Their real-life love story has grown alongside their on-screen partnership.

ON AIR – Which celebrity couples do you love to follow?

CELEBRITY · NOW
- 4 Could the US version of 'Love Island' be winning over British viewers, with fans saying the contestants 'actually fancy each other'?**

Commentators and even a former Islander are reflecting on what the UK dating series could do to attract more viewers. It seems the American edition is gaining popularity here.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of 'Love Island'? Which version do you prefer?

TV · NOW
- 5 Sam Fender and Olivia Dean have made history with their duet 'Rein Me In', breaking a 73-year-old UK singles chart record!**

The track has now spent an incredible 19 non-consecutive weeks at the top of the charts. It's an amazing achievement for both artists.

ON AIR – What's a song that you just can't get enough of right now?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1 **Welsh cycling star Emma Finucane has made Commonwealth Games history, becoming the first sprint cyclist to win four track gold medals!**

It's an incredible achievement for Finucane at the Games in Glasgow. She's truly dominated the sprint cycling events, cementing her place in the record books.

ON AIR – What's been your favourite moment from the Commonwealth Games so far?

CYCLING · UK

2 **Chelsea have officially confirmed the signing of Brighton striker Danny Welbeck, adding some serious firepower to their squad!**

The experienced forward makes the move to Stamford Bridge. Fans will be eager to see him in action for the Blues this season.

ON AIR – Which football transfer are you most excited about this summer?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **England's Joe Root says he's in a 'very different place' as he prepares to embrace his second stint as Test captain.**

Root stepped down from the role four years ago, but is now ready to lead the team once again. He'll be looking to make a strong impact.

ON AIR – Do you think Joe Root is the right man to lead England in Test cricket again?

CRICKET · UK

4 **British boxer Mark Chamberlain delivered a stunning knockout win in Dublin, claiming the IBO light-welterweight belt!**

Chamberlain dropped his opponent, Pierce O'Leary, twice on his way to a dominant 10th-round victory. It was a truly impressive performance.

ON AIR – Have you been following any of the recent boxing action?

BOXING · UK

5 **Elfyn Evans has extended his lead at the top of the World Rally Championship standings after Sami Pajari's win in Finland!**

Evans now holds a commanding 30-point advantage in the championship. It's a strong position for the Welsh driver as the season progresses.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of motorsports, or do you prefer other sports?

MOTOR SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The joy of 'upcycling old furniture' is sweeping across homes, transforming forgotten pieces into cherished new items.**
Many are discovering the satisfaction of giving tired tables, chairs, and cabinets a fresh lease of life with a lick of paint or a creative makeover. It's an eco-friendly way to personalise your living space and save a few pennies too.
- 2 A surprising number of people are turning to 'miniature gardening' as a calming hobby.**
From tiny terrariums to charming fairy gardens in teacups, creating small-scale green worlds offers a delightful escape and a touch of nature, even for those with limited space.
- 3 The trend of 'swapping and sharing books' through neighbourhood libraries is fostering community spirit.**
Little free libraries, often resembling miniature houses, are popping up everywhere, allowing locals to exchange books, discover new authors, and connect over shared literary interests.
- 4 Many are finding a renewed appreciation for the craft of 'baking their own bread' from scratch.**
The simple act of mixing, kneading, and watching dough rise offers a wonderfully therapeutic experience, culminating in the delicious aroma and taste of freshly baked loaves.
- 5 The subtle art of 'wild foraging for edible plants' is gaining popularity among adventurous foodies.**
Guided walks are helping people safely identify and gather seasonal treats like wild garlic, elderflowers, and blackberries, connecting them with nature and adding unique flavours to their cooking.
- 6 Experts are highlighting the benefits of 'taking a 'digital detox' to improve well-being.**
Setting aside time to unplug from screens and engage in offline activities is proving to be a fantastic way to reduce stress, improve sleep, and reconnect with the real world around us.
- 7 The simple pleasure of 'visiting local markets' is experiencing a resurgence.**
Beyond just shopping, people are enjoying the vibrant atmosphere, discovering artisan products, and supporting local producers, making it a lovely outing for the whole family.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if it's going to rain, even though we know it's not very scientific?

ANSWER: STARING INTENSELY AT THE SKY AND TRYING TO 'FEEL' THE RAIN COMING.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: SNIFFING THE TEABAG OR THE HOT MUG FIRST, JUST TO GET THAT 'PREVIEW' AROMA!

TALK TOPIC

- You know those little 'secret shortcuts' or 'hacks' you've discovered in your daily life that just make things so much easier?

Perhaps it's a clever way to peel a stubborn fruit, or a trick to speed up your morning routine. What's your best everyday life hack that you think everyone should know?

- Think about those 'little everyday sounds' that instantly bring a smile to your face or make you feel incredibly content.

It could be the purr of a cat, the distant whistle of a train, or the kettle boiling. What's a simple sound that always brightens your day?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** There is a 'rainforest in Scotland' called the Atlantic Oakwood, which is home to unique mosses, lichens, and ferns.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies use their antennae to smell, but they actually 'taste with their feet'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A 'group of owls' is called a parliament.
- The 'human nose' can remember 50,000 different scents.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The 'loudest animal' on Earth is the sperm whale, whose clicks can reach up to 230 decibels.
- Strawberries are the 'only fruit' with seeds on the outside.
- The 'world's oldest known living tree' is a Great Basin bristlecone pine named Methuselah, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- There are more 'flamingos in the wild' than any other species of bird.
- The 'expression 'bite the bullet'' originated from soldiers biting on lead bullets to endure pain during surgery without anaesthesia.

On this day

Day 215 of the year, 150 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Killing of Pidjiguiti (Guinea-Bissau); Armed Forces Day (Equatorial Guinea); Christian feast day: Blessed Augustin Kažotić; Christian feast day: George Freeman Bragg, W. E. B. Du Bois (Episcopal Church). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1963 — Lisa Ann Walter, American actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1954 — Gary Peters, English footballer and manager
- 1950 — John Landis, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1993 — Ola Abidogun, English sprinter
- 1963 — James Hetfield, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1930 — James Komack, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter (died 1997)
- 1956 — Dave Cloud, American singer-songwriter and actor (died 2015)
- 1980 — Nadia Ali, Libyan-American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1981 — Senegalese opposition parties, under the leadership of Mamadou Dia, launch the Antiimperialist Action Front – Suxxali Reew Mi.
- 2014 — A 6.1 magnitude earthquake kills at least 617 people and injures more than 2,400 in Yunnan, China.
- 1936 — Jesse Owens wins the 100 metre dash, defeating Ralph Metcalfe, at the Berlin Olympics.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1981 — Senegalese opposition parties, under the leadership of Mamadou Dia, launch the Antiimperialist Action Front – Suxxali Reew Mi.
- 1949 — The Basketball Association of America and the National Basketball League finalize the merger that would create the National Basketball Association.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2007 — Former deputy director of the Chilean secret police Raúl Iturriaga is captured after having been on the run following a conviction for kidnapping.
- 1940 — World War II: Italian forces begin the invasion of British Somaliland.

- 2014 — A 6.1 magnitude earthquake kills at least 617 people and injures more than 2,400 in Yunnan, China.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 216 of the year, 149 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aristarchus; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecilia Cesarini; Christian feast day: Euphronius; Christian feast day: Blessed Frédéric Janssoone. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — Steve Phillips, English footballer
- 1985 — Crystal Bowersox, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1998 — Lil Skies, American rapper
- 1970 — John August, American director and screenwriter
- 1983 — Greta Gerwig, American actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1962 — Paul Reynolds, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1994 — Bobby Shmurda, American rapper
- 1941 — Cliff Nobles, American musician (died 2008)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1983 — Jean-Baptiste Ouédraogo, president of the military government of Upper Volta, is ousted from power in a coup d'état led by Captain Thomas Sankara.
- 1924 — Diplomatic relations between Mexico and the Soviet Union are established.
- 1964 — Civil rights movement: Civil rights workers Michael Schwerner, Andrew Goodman and James Chaney are found dead in Mississippi after disappearing on June 21.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2018 — Crisis in Venezuela: Seven people are injured when two drones detonate explosives on Avenida Bolívar, Caracas while president Nicolás Maduro is giving a speech to the Venezuelan National Guard.
- 2019 — Nine people are killed and 26 injured in a shooting in Dayton, Ohio. This comes only 13 hours after another mass shooting in El Paso, Texas, where 23 people were killed.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)